CopernicusLAC Infrastructure Support

Training Plan

Advancing Earth Science

Title	CopernicusLAC Infrastructure Training Plan
Prepared by	Terradue
Reference	T2-ESA-COPLACI-PL-26-049
Issue	2.4
Date	2026-10-28
Status	Issued
Document Type	Plan
Configuration	Configured document
ESA Contract No:	4000144570/24/I-KE

Change record

Date	Issue	Section	Page	Comment
2026-10-01	1.0	All	All	Initial draft
2026-10-12	2.0	All	All	Training objectives, delivery approach and participant profile.
2026-10-22	2.1	All	All	Training material structure and document presentation.
2026-10-23	2.2	All	All	Maintenance update for Deployment Guide v2.2: references, tier ownership, security boundaries and readiness gates.
2026-10-26	2.3	All	All	Teaching guidance, practical examples and Deployment Guide references.
2026-10-28	2.4	All	All	Team review incorporated: revised calendar, foundation learning, application and onsite deployment, individual assessment and handover support.

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1 Purpose and scope

This document defines the CopernicusLAC infrastructure training programme for AIG system administrators and platform engineers. It sets out the learning objectives, prerequisites, delivery schedule, practical activities, responsibilities and assessment arrangements that will support operational readiness and knowledge transfer under the project's Training, Transfer and Handover Plan (D5).

The programme will combine remote workshops, targeted foundation learning and a mandatory onsite event. Practical activities will cover access and identity management, deployment and controlled change, data ingestion and discovery, Burned Area Severity (BAS) and DInSAR processing, routine operations, fault diagnosis and scoped recovery. Deployment practice will progress from a controlled configuration change to a small application and a representative platform service.

The programme will run from 6 November 2026 to 5 February 2027 and will use the target infrastructure. The module outcomes and individual assessment records will establish the practical competencies demonstrated by each trainee. Full-platform rebuild, infrastructure administration and advanced recovery will be addressed through the wider handover responsibilities set out in Section 10.

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2 Teaching approach and workload

Each workshop will follow one operational story and one principal practical outcome. The trainer will explain the necessary concepts, demonstrate once, guide practice and check individual evidence. Deployment will progress from a controlled GitOps change in M01 to a small application in M05 and a representative platform service onsite. Prepared configuration and Deployment Guide v2.2 procedures will support the practical work.

The following arrangements will apply across the workshops, covering practical participation, preparation, recording results and handling technical difficulties.

Aspect	How it will work
Demonstration and practice	The trainer will demonstrate the task and explain the main steps. Trainees will then perform the practical activities with guidance and feedback
Practical instructions	Trainees will receive step-by-step instructions and prepared configuration examples. The trainer will explain the commands and settings needed to understand and complete each task
Recording results	Each trainee will use the participant worksheet to record what they did, the result obtained and any assistance needed. The trainer will review these records to identify progress and areas requiring further practice.
Preparation before each workshop	Trainees will read the workshop instructions beforehand, normally requiring 20–30 minutes. Any prerequisite learning identified in M00 will require additional preparation, as described in Section 2.1.
Technical difficulties	If a technical problem prevents an exercise, the trainer will record the issue and identify who will resolve it. A demonstration may be used to continue the explanation, but trainees will complete the practical task once the issue is resolved.

Remote workshops will last 150 or 180 minutes, including a 10-minute break. Module guides will specify the agenda, practical tasks and expected results for each session.

M00 will identify prerequisite gaps through a short self-assessment and practical checks. The trainer and AIG coordinator will agree selected learning, completion dates and follow-up checks for each trainee. AIG will ensure that gaps are addressed before dependent workshops. Full courses and certification will not be required.

The programme will accommodate three to five trainees. All three full onsite days and the final four-hour morning will be mandatory. The final morning will be reserved for practical review and individual feedback, targeted repetition and closure of outstanding actions.

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2.1 Foundation learning and preparation

The resources below will provide recommended learning for the prerequisite skills. During M00, existing knowledge and practical skills will be assessed, and any preparation gaps will be identified for each trainee. AIG will ensure that these gaps are addressed before the relevant workshops, using the recommended resources or equivalent learning. Completion of full courses and certification will not be required.

Linux — Linux Foundation: Introduction to Linux LFS101
Trainees will review shell navigation, files, permissions, processes and logs, selecting the relevant lessons according to their experience. Preparation must be completed before M02.

Networking — Cisco Networking Academy: Networking Basics
Trainees will review IP addressing, ports, DNS and transport protocols, focusing on the concepts needed to understand platform connectivity. Preparation must be completed before M02.

Containers — Docker: Build and share a containerized application
Trainees will review container images, running containers, ports and logs. Public image publication will not be required. Basic image and container concepts must be reviewed before M01; the remaining preparation must be completed before M05.

Kubernetes — Linux Foundation: Introduction to Kubernetes LFS158
Trainees will review workloads, Services, configuration and persistent storage, focusing on deploying and inspecting applications in an existing cluster. Basic resource and status concepts must be reviewed before M01; deployment-related preparation must be completed before M05.

Git — GitHub Learn: Introduction to Git
Trainees will review repositories, branches, commits, differences and recovery. These concepts will be applied to GitLab during M01. Preparation must be completed before M01.

YAML — Ansible documentation: YAML Syntax
Trainees will review mappings, lists, indentation, strings and booleans through focused reading. Ansible-specific training will not be required. Preparation must be completed before M01.

Object storage — Amazon S3 User Guide and StorageGRID S3 access keys
Trainees will review buckets, objects, object keys, access credentials and permissions. AWS documentation will introduce S3 concepts; StorageGRID documentation will provide platform-specific guidance. Preparation must be completed before M04.

Identity management — Keycloak Server Administration Guide and Getting Started walkthrough
Trainees will review authentication, authorization, single sign-on, realms, users, roles, groups and application clients. Selected reading will prepare them for practical user-access checks and scoped configuration during M03. Preparation must be completed before M03.

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3 Calendar and participation time

Date	Session and purpose	Time
29 Oct 2026	Training plan shared with ESA and AIG	-
6 Nov	Briefing: programme, objectives, prerequisites and participation arrangements	60 min
12 Nov	M00 Platform orientation and access	150 min
19 Nov	M01 Deployment ownership and controlled GitOps change	180 min
26 Nov	M02 Diagnose platform foundations	180 min
3 Dec	M03 User access and working services	180 min
17 Dec	M04 Ingest and discover a small dataset	180 min
14 Jan 2027	M05 Deploy and verify a small application	150 min
21 Jan	M06 Run BAS and DInSAR	150 min
28 Jan	M07 Daily operations and onsite readiness	150 min
2 Feb	M08 — Day 1: Representative platform-component deployment	6 hours (on-site)
3 Feb	M08 — Day 2: Operations, processing services execution and diagnosis	6 hours (on-site)
4 Feb	M08 — Day 3: Diagnosis, controlled change, rollback and scoped recovery	6 hours (on-site)
5 Feb	M08 — Day 4: practical review and individual feedback, targeted repetition and closure	4 hours (on-site)

Remote sessions will start at 09:00 Panama / 15:00 Rome. The briefing will last one hour, and the eight remote workshops will total 22 hours, including a 10-minute break per workshop. The mandatory onsite event will comprise three days of six teaching hours each and a final four-hour morning.

Total scheduled participation will be 45 hours: 23 remote hours and 22 onsite teaching hours. Foundation learning and preparation between workshops will be additional. No session will take place on 10 December, and training will pause from 21 December 2026 to 10 January 2027. The programme will conclude on 5 February 2027.

Participant materials will be released at least three working days before each workshop. M00 will identify prerequisite gaps, and AIG will ensure that trainees address them before the relevant modules.

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4 Foundation workshop outcomes

Module	Learner performs	Evidence and boundary
M00	Signs in with their own accounts (Keycloak with OTP, Rancher kubeconfig, GitLab) and runs read-only checks on the cluster. Places each platform component in its deployment tier and names its owner. Completes a self-assessment and short skill checks, then agrees a personal preparation plan.	Result of each access check; self-assessment and skill-check results; learning actions with completion dates and follow-up checks. Read-only: no changes to the platform.
M01	Explains the deployment tiers and who changes each one. Changes one permitted field through a GitLab merge request, verifies that Argo CD and Crossplane applied it, and restores the original value with a revert.	Merge request and commit reference; Argo CD Application and Crossplane Object status; ConfigMap value before, after and after the revert. Training repository and Application only: no existing platform controller or service is installed or reconfigured.
M02	Diagnoses one prepared fault on a training route (secret, certificate, routing or workload) using read-only status checks, working from the lower layers upwards, and names the responsible owner.	Observed condition, likely layer, next check and owner. The trainer plants and repairs the fault; trainees make no cluster changes.
M03	Adds a role or group to their own test user, verifies the effect with a fresh login on App Hub (starts a notebook) and Drive (opens a file), then removes it and confirms that access is denied.	Test user, role changed, fresh-login results, restoration. Limited to test users: no realm, client, policy or service changes.

Each session will use a prepared training scenario with defined expected results. M00 will introduce the user journey and access arrangements. M03 will include practical notebook and file-access checks using App Hub and Drive. Availability of these services will be verified before M03; any unavailable practical activity will be rescheduled and recorded as outstanding until completed.

M01 will explain the deployment sequence, dependencies and management ownership before a controlled change. Trainees will distinguish manual Tier 1 applications, helmfile-managed Tier 2 components and automated Tier 3 resources. Using a validated Crossplane Object schema and the training Argo CD application, they will change, verify and restore one message field in an existing configuration.

The module packs define exact tasks, evidence and assessment.

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5 Operational workshop outcomes

Module	Learner performs	Evidence and boundary
M04	Follows a real ingestion started by the assigned operator, then personally searches the catalogue for the new item, checks its metadata and opens its asset.	Initiating operator and ingestion reference; each trainee's search, item identifier, metadata checked and asset-access result. A synthetic item alone does not demonstrate ingestion.
M05	Deploys a prepared small application (workload and Service) through the approved GitOps path, verifies that it is ready and returns the expected result, then removes it.	Merge request references; ready workload; functional output; removal confirmed. Existing platform controllers are used, not reinstalled.
M06	Submits at least one reference processing run through the processing API with their own account, follows it to completion, and explains how BAS and DInSAR results reach storage and the catalogue.	Run identifiers, final status, output location and catalogue item; explanation of both result paths. Outputs still pending are closed in M07.
M07	Runs the daily health checks, triages one incident from the evidence, writes a handoff note with a named escalation owner, and closes the pending M06 evidence.	Daily-check record; triage evidence; handoff note with owner; closed M06 outputs. Privileged checks may be run by the trainer and interpreted by the trainee.
M08	With the group, deploys and verifies a selected platform service (candidate: STAC API and Titiler on pgSTAC), each trainee owning one named step. Operates the platform, diagnoses faults, makes a change with rollback, participates in scoped recovery and verifies the restored result, and completes an individual observed attempt on Day 4.	Named deployment step per trainee; configuration, health and functional evidence; assistance level per task. All four onsite dates are mandatory; full-platform rebuild competence is not inferred.

M05 will combine a small application deployment with the operational integration checkpoint. Using prepared configuration and the authorised management path, trainees will deploy a workload and Service, verify readiness and a functional result, and remove the application through the documented process. This activity will prepare them for onsite component deployment. Required platform and processing paths will be verified before M06.

M08 will comprise three six-hour teaching days and a four-hour final morning. Day 1 will cover representative component deployment; Day 2 operations, EO processing services execution and selected diagnosis; Day 3 further diagnosis, controlled change, rollback and scoped recovery; and Day 4 practical review and individual feedback, targeted repetition and closure. The trainer will guide a shared sequence. Trainees will rotate between performing actions, following the procedure and reviewing results.

5.1 Onsite deployment workshop

Day 1 will allocate 45 minutes to sequence and ownership, 45 minutes to prepared configuration and dependencies, 120 minutes to guided installation, 60 minutes to functional verification, 60 minutes to a trainee-led change and rollback, and 30 minutes to evidence and runbook corrections. Breaks will be additional.

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The deployment workshop will cover one substantial service or a small coherent component group. STAC API/Titiler/pgSTAC with a prepared external PostgreSQL service is a candidate. The selected scope will be confirmed before the onsite event against Deployment Guide v2.2, exercise duration and isolation requirements. Dependencies, configuration and reset procedures will be prepared beforehand; trainees will install the selected component in the exercise target.

Day 4 will provide four teaching hours for individual practical checks, targeted repetition and closure. With up to five trainees, each will receive an approximately 30-minute observed attempt while others undertake assigned read-only reviews; the remaining time will support feedback and residual actions. Assessment evidence will also be collected throughout the preceding days.

Availability of CWL runners, processing packages and token integration will be verified before the relevant practical activities.

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6 Target preparation and readiness

Before each workshop, Terradue will coordinate with AIG and, where relevant, Ifx-Ufinet to verify that the access, services and exercise environment are ready. The checks will apply only to the activities planned for that workshop.

Readiness check	What will be verified
Trainee access	Each trainee will be able to sign in and perform the authorised exercise tasks.
Required services	The platform components and connections needed for the exercise will be available and working.
Exercise resources	Training accounts, configuration, data and storage or computing capacity will be available.
Exercise validation	The practical instructions will have been tested on the target environment, with known expected results and a suitable duration.
Safe execution and cleanup	The exercise will have defined limits to protect operational services, and a procedure will be available to remove changes or restore the starting state. Recovery exercises will also require a usable backup and a tested recovery procedure.
Technical support	The responsible contacts and escalation route will be identified for any issue that prevents the exercise from proceeding.

If a readiness requirement is not met, Terradue will coordinate with the responsible party to resolve the issue or reschedule the affected practical activity. Any demonstration provided in the meantime will be recorded as observed learning; the practical outcome will remain outstanding until completed by the trainee. Technical issues will be recorded separately from gaps in trainee preparation. Deployment Guide v2.2 will provide the technical reference; readiness will be established through checks on the actual target environment.

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7 Infrastructure and foundation coverage

The table below identifies the modules in which trainees will encounter each infrastructure component and the practical activities covered. Some components will be used as existing dependencies; their inclusion will not imply that trainees will install or administer them.

Component and Deployment Guide sections	Relevant modules	Practical scope
RKE2, Rancher, Cilium and CoreDNS — §§3.1–3.2	M00, M07, M08	Trainees will identify the cluster and infrastructure responsibilities, inspect health indicators and perform relevant checks during onsite exercises. Cluster provisioning and infrastructure recovery will remain with Ifx-Ufinet within its assigned responsibilities.
Longhorn, monitoring, DNS and load balancing — §§2.5, 3.3–3.4, 11.2	M02, M07, M08	Trainees will inspect relevant indicators and dependencies during diagnosis and operational checks. Installation and administration of these shared services will remain outside the practical exercises.
PostgreSQL, PostGIS and StorageGRID — §3.5	M03–M07; M08 where required by the selected deployment	Trainees will use the existing database and object-storage services, verify application access and identify dependency failures. Deployment and recovery of the external services will remain outside these exercises.
Harbor and container registries — §§3.6–3.7, 5.5, 5.7	M05, M08	Trainees will use the configured registry during deployment and verify image access. Registry installation and administration will remain outside these exercises. Mail services referenced in these sections will be treated as supporting dependencies, with no dedicated practical task.
GitLab, Argo CD and Crossplane — §§2.4, 5.1–5.8, 6.1–6.2	M01, M05, M08	Trainees will follow the relevant deployment path, make a controlled configuration change, inspect reconciliation and deploy the selected application or service. The existing delivery controllers will be used rather than reinstalled.
SOPS/age, Vault, External Secrets Operator and certificates — §§4.4, 5.3, 7.1–7.3	M02; M05 and M08 as deployment dependencies	Trainees will inspect permitted configuration and status information to diagnose secret or certificate dependencies. Deployment exercises will use prepared integration. Privileged secret-management setup and administration will remain outside the exercises.
Contour, Envoy and Knative — §§5.3, 7.3, 7.6–7.7	M02; M05 and M08 where required by the selected application	Trainees will diagnose routing dependencies and verify application access through the configured services. Installation of shared controllers and changes to shared routing infrastructure will remain outside the exercises.

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Component and Deployment Guide sections	Relevant modules	Practical scope
Keycloak and OPA — §§7.4–7.6	M03	Trainees will perform an authorised test-user role change, verify access and restore the initial role. Keycloak will support the practical task; OPA will be explained as an authorisation dependency where applicable. Realm setup, policy authoring and broader identity administration will remain outside the exercise.

Component references will follow Deployment Guide v2.2, with operational responsibilities described in the Infrastructure System Design Document (D4), §2.2. Each exercise will use the management method specified for the relevant component and deployment tier. In particular, Tier 2 Crossplane components will be managed through helmfile, while the M01 exercise will use the configured Argo CD path for a controlled Tier 3 resource change. Module instructions will identify the applicable procedure and the actions authorised for trainees.

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8 Application coverage and integration checkpoint

Component and guide	Training coverage	Required observation
Portal, App Hub, Drive; §§10.1, 12.1	M03 scoped access and user services	Working notebook and file-access checks on the target services
GitLab, Harbor and SSO; §§5.4–5.7, 12.1–12.3	M01 repository use; access boundaries	Trainees will sign in to GitLab through its configured HTTPS address and access the repository required for the exercise.
STAC, pgSTAC, TiTiler, browsers; §§8.3–8.6	M04 ingestion; M06 output discovery; candidate M08 representative service deployment	Real item, metadata and authorised asset access. STAC API/pgSTAC is a candidate for the onsite deployment, subject to rehearsal and isolation.
Argo Workflows, CWL, Calrissian; §§9.1, 9.4	M04 status; M06 processing; M07 diagnosis	Available runner and actual completed output path
Processing API and packages; §§9.3–9.4	M06 BAS and DInSAR operations	Packages available; real-token end-to-end path verified
Argo Events, CloudEvents, Kafka; §§8.1, 9.2	Inspect the task's actual event path	Rehearsed evidence; no shared messaging installation

Before M06, the integration checkpoint will verify the required runners and packages, authentication with trainee accounts, BAS and DInSAR execution, accessible outputs, and suitable quotas and runtimes. The check will address the integration items identified in Deployment Guide v2.2 §§9.4 and 12.1–12.2.

The integration checkpoint will establish readiness for the processing exercises. Completion of a practical outcome will require trainee execution and verification on the target environment. Unavailable services or processing paths will be recorded with an owner and a completion date. Formal platform acceptance and wider D5 handover requirements will be addressed through project governance.

Training procedures will reflect the validated target configuration.

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9 Assessment and completion records

Progress will be reviewed through the practical activities carried out during the workshops. The purpose will be to reinforce understanding, identify where further practice is needed and prepare the AIG team for its operational responsibilities. No formal examination or numerical grading will be used.

Trainees will use the Deployment Guide, worksheets and runbooks, and will be encouraged to ask questions and seek support. The trainer will provide feedback during the exercises and ensure that each participant has opportunities to perform relevant tasks, check results and discuss the appropriate next steps.

A short record will be maintained for each workshop, covering the activities completed, any topics requiring further practice and any technical issues that prevented completion. Individual follow-up needs will be noted where useful, without requiring detailed assessment forms for every task.

The following statuses will be used to record practical progress and identify follow-up needs. They will not represent grades or examination results.

Progress status	Meaning
Activity completed	The trainee has performed the task and checked the result, using the documentation and trainer support as needed.
Further practice recommended	The trainee has participated but would benefit from repeating the task or clarifying specific steps.
Activity pending	The practical task has not yet been performed, for example because of a technical issue or insufficient time. A follow-up action will be identified.

The final onsite morning will consolidate learning through practical tasks, questions and targeted repetition. It will also provide an opportunity to address outstanding difficulties and agree any further support needed.

At the end of the programme, Terradue will provide a concise completion summary covering participation, practical activities completed and recommended follow-up actions. Activities that could not be performed will be clearly identified. This summary will support AIG’s allocation of operational responsibilities and the wider project handover process.

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10 Responsibilities and handover arrangements

The following table identifies responsibilities for delivering and participating in the training, together with the related responsibilities for platform operations and handover. Operational responsibilities will follow the project's established allocation of duties.

Party or role	Responsibilities during training	Responsibilities for operations and handover
AIG coordinator	Coordinate participation, access, attendance and completion of prerequisite learning. Follow up on preparation needs and outstanding activities.	Coordinate AIG's assignment of operational roles and follow-up actions identified during training.
AIG Platform Operations	Participate in practical activities covering deployment, routine checks, diagnosis and controlled changes.	Perform platform operations within assigned authority and maintain operational procedures and runbooks.
AIG Technical Support and Data Management	Participate in exercises covering user support, incidents, ingestion and data access.	Maintain the service-support and data-management activities assigned under the operations concept.
Terradue	Prepare and deliver the training, guide practical activities, provide feedback and record follow-up needs.	Provide the guaranteed three months of post-handover support and complete the technical handover activities assigned to Terradue.
Ifx-Ufinet	Support access and infrastructure dependencies within its responsibility, and participate in the relevant M08 activities.	Maintain and recover the provider-managed infrastructure and services within its assigned scope.
Project management	Coordinate the training scope, schedule and any changes requiring a project decision.	Review outstanding handover actions and determine formal acceptance in accordance with project arrangements.

The training will contribute to the wider D5 programme by preparing AIG personnel for the operational tasks covered by the modules. Practical activities will include deployment of selected platform components, routine operations, diagnosis and scoped recovery. Full-platform deployment, infrastructure upgrades and advanced recovery will be addressed through the wider handover programme, with responsibilities, supporting documentation and completion criteria identified before formal handover.

Terradue will provide three months of post-handover support. The support period, contact points and arrangements for raising and following up requests will be recorded at handover. Outstanding training activities and recommended further practice will be included in the completion summary to help prioritise follow-up support.

ifx-Ufinet will participate in M08 and support activities within its infrastructure responsibilities. Before the recovery exercise, Terradue, AIG and ifx-Ufinet will confirm their respective roles and verify that a documented recovery procedure, a usable backup and a suitably isolated recovery environment are available. The exercise will include checks to confirm that the recovered service or data is usable.

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11 Release preparation and change control

Each module will be supported by a versioned training pack and a prepared exercise environment. The following table defines the preparation milestones, deliverables and responsible parties.

When	Deliverable	Responsible party
Before programme delivery	Participant list, calendar, responsibilities and attendance arrangements	AIG and project authority with Terradue
Before M00	Individual access check, exercise assignment and available orientation environment	Trainer and access owners
Before M01	Validated target configuration, trainee repository access, authorised change path and reset procedure	Trainer and platform owner
Before each release	Verified practical instructions, service availability and module readiness	Trainer
At least 3 working days before	Participant worksheet, slides, practical instructions and exercise assignments will be released	Trainer via agreed distribution channel
Before M06	Verified processing packages, runner, authentication, BAS/DInSAR outputs and exercise duration	Trainer and service owner
Before onsite travel	M07 readiness; selected deployment service, tested configuration and reset; fault scenarios; actual backup and scoped restore runbook; mandatory four-day agenda	AIG, trainer and infrastructure owner
After each session	Consolidated evidence, restored exercise environment and assigned follow-up actions	Trainer and AIG coordinator

Each participant pack will include slides, a worksheet, practical instructions and the relevant Deployment Guide sections. Questions will be addressed during the session; unresolved points will be recorded with an owner and follow-up action. Trainer-only assessment answers and fault scenarios will be retained by Terradue. Access credentials will be provided separately.

Outstanding prerequisites or technical issues will be recorded against the affected learning outcome. Additional completion sessions may be scheduled where required, with timing and participation coordinated by Terradue and AIG. The final onsite morning will remain reserved for practical review and individual feedback, targeted repetition and closure.

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